CLASS 8 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 03

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 40 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one literary passage (poem or story) with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Why We Should Read Books

In a world of video games, short clips and instant messages, a thick book can look rather old-fashioned. Yet nothing has yet replaced the quiet pleasure of reading. A book does not flash or buzz; it waits patiently for the reader to enter it and, once inside, lets her go wherever she wishes, to a jungle in Africa, a palace in Rajasthan or a spaceship millions of miles away.

Reading is also one of the best exercises for the mind. Researchers have found that students who read for pleasure for even twenty minutes a day develop a larger vocabulary, write better and concentrate for longer than those who do not. Unlike a film, which supplies pictures ready-made, a book asks the reader to imagine the scene for herself, and imagination, like a muscle, grows stronger with use.

Books also teach us to understand other people. When we read the story of a poor boy who wins a scholarship or a girl who braves a flood to save her village, we feel, for a while, what they feel. This habit of seeing through another person's eyes is called empathy, and it is the foundation of kindness. Many great leaders have confessed that their characters were shaped by the books they read as children.

The habit of reading, however, does not grow by itself. Parents and teachers can help by keeping books within easy reach, by reading aloud, and by allowing children to choose what they read. A comic or an adventure story is a perfectly good beginning. The important thing is to start. Libraries, which are free, are a good place to look; and a school that sets aside a quiet reading period every week does a great service to its students.

(i) According to the writer, a thick book may look: 1

(a) exciting **(b)** old-fashioned

(c) dangerous **(d)** expensive

(ii) Students who read for twenty minutes a day: 1

(a) play more **(b)** sleep less

(c) develop a larger vocabulary **(d)** avoid homework

(iii) A book differs from a film because it: 1

(a) is shorter **(b)** supplies ready-made pictures

(c) has sound **(d)** asks the reader to imagine

(iv) 'Empathy' means: 1

(a) feeling proud **(b)** feeling what another person feels

(c) being afraid **(d)** being very clever

(v) Which is NOT suggested to help children read? 1

(a) Letting them choose books **(b)** Keeping books within reach
(c) Forbidding comics **(d)** Reading aloud

(vi) State whether True or False: Reading has been replaced completely by video games. Correct if false. 1

(vii) How is imagination compared to a muscle? 1

(viii) Why do we feel what the characters feel when we read their stories? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'free to use' or 'near at hand'. (Hint: paragraph 4) 1

(x) Name two ways in which parents and teachers can encourage reading. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Literary Passage — Poem / Story) — 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Rain on the Roof

The first drop fell on the dusty tin,
A single note, a tiny din,
And then a thousand followed fast—
The heat of the day was gone at last.

The peacock cried from the mango tree,
The washing fluttered wild and free,
Mother ran with a basket of clothes
While the courtyard bloomed like a damp red rose.

We children raced to the open door
And stuck out our hands to catch some more;
Each drop was cool as a silver coin
Dropped by the clouds that had come to join.

Grandfather watched from his creaking chair
And said, "I have felt this very air
When I was small and the world was new—
The rain remembers us, it's true."

The gutters sang and the puddles grew,
The old brown cow gave a thoughtful moo,
And we, with paper boats in hand,
Set sail on seas of wet, soft sand.

(i) The first raindrop fell on: 1
(a) the tin roof **(b)** a boat
(c) the cow **(d)** the mango tree

(ii) The sound of the raindrops is described as: 1
(a) a soft whisper **(b)** a tiny din
(c) a loud thunder **(d)** a song

(iii) The raindrops are compared to: 1
(a) silver coins **(b)** diamonds **(c)** pearls **(d)** stars

(iv) Grandfather says 'the rain remembers us' because: 1
(a) the rain feels the same as in his childhood **(b)** he is fond of poetry
(c) he has a good memory for names **(d)** he is a farmer

(v) The children finally: 1

(a) sail paper boats **(b)** run away

(c) go to school **(d)** sleep

(vi) Why was the end of the heat welcomed? 1

(vii) What did Mother do when it began to rain? 1

(viii) Name one bird or animal mentioned in the poem. 1

(ix) Pick out one example of personification from the poem. 1

(x) What did the children do to catch the rain? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND